

The Ultimate Thornton ADU Permit Cheat Sheet

Thornton, Adams County — 2026

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The information provided is strictly for educational purposes and does not constitute legal, architectural, or professional urban planning advice. Always consult the official city planning department before making any decisions or starting any construction project.

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■ Thornton ADU — Key Regulations & Local Contacts

Zoning Rules Overview

Regulation	Requirement
Maximum Size	1,000 sq ft
Property Setbacks	5 ft rear, 5 ft side
Extra Parking	Required (1 space)
Owner Occupancy	Required

■ Local Planning Department

Department: Community Development Department

Phone: (303) 538-7230

Email: planning@thorntonco.gov

Address: 9500 Civic Center Dr, Thornton, CO 80229

Hours: Mon–Fri, 8am–5pm

■ Key Online Resources

- **ADU Information:** <https://thorntonco.gov>
- **Zoning Map:** <https://thorntonco.gov/gis>
- **Permit Portal:** <https://thorntonco.gov/permits>

■ Maximum Estimated Permit Fees

- Building permit fee: \$1,800
- Impact / development fees: \$3,500
- Plan check fee: \$750

■ Thornton ADU — Step-by-Step Project Checklist

- Verify zoning compliance — confirm your lot is zoned for ADU use
- Check the official zoning map at: <https://thorntonco.gov/gis>
- Measure lot size, setbacks, and height limits against your design
- Prepare a preliminary site plan (property lines, building locations, setbacks)
- Draft floor plan showing ADU layout (bedroom, kitchen, bathroom)
- Complete the building permit application — available at: <https://thorntonco.gov/permits>
- Gather required documents: site plan, floor plan, elevations, proof of ownership
- Submit complete application package to the Planning Department in person or online
- Pay plan check fee and building permit fee
- Wait for plan review (typically 4-8 weeks — respond to correction notices promptly)
- Schedule required inspections: foundation, framing, electrical, plumbing, final
- Obtain Certificate of Occupancy once all inspections pass

■ *Tip: Schedule a pre-application meeting with the Thornton Planning Department early in your process — they can identify issues before you spend time and money on detailed plans.*